

Be Prepared for Group Discussions

What is Group Discussion?

A Group Discussion

- Is a positive exchange of views on a particular topic.
- Is time bound and open to all present in the group.
- Is not a competition or an argument where any one person wins.
- Is often used as mass grading process.
- All the participants in a Group Discussion are expected to present their opinion or views.



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Why is a Group Discussion conducted?

A Group Discussion is primarily conducted to check your interpersonal skills, such as

- Your communication skills
- Your ability to work in a team
- Your ability to express your point of view
- Your listening skills
- Your ability to handle criticism
- Your knowledge of the subject
- Your overall personality

But that does not mean that you need not have subject specific knowledge. It helps to have core subject knowledge.



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Points to remember in Group Discussion

Points you will be assessed on

- Clarity
- Body language
- Listening
- Tone of voice
- Appropriate language
- Courtesy
- Conciseness
- Confidence
- Correctness



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Do's

- Dress formally.
- Maintain eye contact with all the group members.
- Have a neutral tone of voice.
- Try to initiate the Group Discussion.
- Express your point of view at the earliest.
- Listen to all the points made.
- Be open minded about topics.
- Get the Group Discussion back on track if it has gone astray.
- Involve all the participants.
- Try to summarize the Group Discussion.
- Keep track of time.



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Don'ts

- Don't let a small group dominate the discussion.
- Don't let the discussion drift away from the given topic.
- Don't interrupt mid sentence.
- Don't take any topic personally.
- Don't have an emotional outburst or shout.
- Don't force others to think the way you do, try to convince them with good reasoning.
- Don't agree with all points of view.
- Don't be biased.



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Common Phrases

Context	Phrase
Agreeing	"I agree with the point made" "That is an excellent point"
Disagreeing	"I'm sorry but ... " "That is a good point but ... " "I'm afraid that might not work out as .."
Making suggestions	"I suggest that .." "We should ... " "One way is to .."
Requesting suggestions	"Any Suggestions?" "What do you recommend?" "Do you think we should .."